



GOD'S *great gift* OF LOVE

SUNDAY

TODAY'S GIFT

Discover and share
God's boundless,
life-filling love.

MEMORY VERSE

We love Him because
He first loved us.
1 John 4:19 NKJV

MEMORY VERSE ACTIVITIES

Cut out paper hearts or use heart-shaped sticky notes. Write each word of the verse and the Bible reference on separate hearts. Then, arrange them in the correct order.



INTRODUCTION

God's Endless Love

God is pure love. Love flows from His heart to us, and then His love flows between us. We express our love for Him in the ways we love each other and how we serve and worship God. Before the Fall, love was the only operating system in the universe, and when sin is eradicated, love will be the focus of all our relationships forever.

Although the cosmic conflict is currently being fought in the universe, it is not the overarching theme. The Big Picture of the universe is that God is love, and His love will overcome and endure forever. As humans, our awareness of God's magnificent and extravagant love is blurry and limited. But one day, we will see Him face to face. Then, we will spend the rest of eternity discovering new facets of His love that are completely beyond our comprehension as human beings.

In our worship times this week, we will explore some of the dimensions of God's love expressed through His creations, relations (marriage), and celebrations (Sabbath).

DEVOTIONAL

God's Great Gift of Love

Lara rested her head against Daddy's chest. She could hear his heart beating ba-bump...ba-bump...ba-bump... "Daddy," Lara looked at Daddy's smiling face, "What is your heart whispering?"

"My heart is saying that I'm alive! And it says I love you, and I love mommy, and I love Luke!" Daddy kissed his finger and touched the tip of Lara's nose. She giggled.

"Daddy, how does all that love get into your heart?" Lara patted Daddy's chest.

"Well, it happens like this. God is so full of love that we can't imagine how much He loves us! His love is so big that it will take forever for us to learn about it, and we'll never come to the end of discovering His wonderful love!"

Luke tried to imagine the size of God's love. But he couldn't. "Wow! That's a lot of love! I can't even stretch my brain around that!"

"How did God's love get from His heart to your heart?" Lara was still curious.

"Well, when God made Adam and Eve, He loved them very much. He spent time with them, and He listened to them. He made many wonderful things for them to see, and smell and taste and enjoy. God cared for His beloved children, and, as He loved them, He filled their hearts with love. Adam and Eve learned how to love and care for each other. When they had babies, they loved them and filled up their hearts with love too!"

Daddy picked up a pitcher of grape juice. "Imagine that this pitcher is filled with God's love. God pours it into our hearts like this..." He poured the juice into four glasses, one for each of them. "And we pour our love into each other's glasses too. God feels our love. He doesn't need us to fill His heart with love, but He enjoys watching His children care for each other."

Lara and Luke drank some of the grape juice. “MMM, delicious!” Luke tipped his head back to get the last drop.

“It’s so sweet and good!” said Lara, “just like God’s love!”

“God is loving us all the time,” said Mommy. “We can’t always see it, and we can’t always feel it. But if we look very closely and listen very carefully, we can find His love in all kinds of places.”

“Yes! I saw God’s love today when Daddy helped you carry the groceries!” exclaimed Lara.

Luke remembered seeing a bird with wool in her beak. “And I saw God’s love when I watched a bird making a nest for her eggs!”

“And I feel God’s love when we’re all together, having one big hug!” Daddy put his strong arms around everyone, and they laughed as he squeezed them gently.

“God’s love is around us all the time,” said Mommy. We just have to notice it and share it with others.”



PRAYING
TOGETHER

Alphabet Prayer of God’s love

- Go through the alphabet and praise God for His love that is A – Abundant, Amazing; B – Blessing, Bountiful; C – Caring, Close...find at least one word for each letter.
- Or fill a small cloth bag with alphabet letters or write each letter on a small card. Take turns to choose a letter and roll a dice to find a number. Then find 5 things or words to describe God’s love beginning with M; or 3 words beginning with R, etc.

MAKING MEMORIES



Family Activities



God's Gift of Love

- Wrap a cardboard box in plain paper like a present.
- Tie a pretty bow around it.
- Talk about how God loves us (Provider, Forgiver, Father, etc.).
- On the wrapped box, write each way God shows love and draw a heart around it until the box is full.
- For ideas, read Psalms 23, 103, 145; 1 Corinthians 13; and 1 John 4.



God's Love Scavenger Hunt

- Have each family member find three items that remind them of God's love.
- Display the items on a tray and let everyone explain their choices.
- Arrange the items in a heart shape, photograph from above, and turn it into a poster.
- Keep adding new items to the display throughout the week.
- Alternative: Fill a wide-mouth jar with 20 love reminders and cover them with rice or millet. Seal it, then rotate or shake the jar to uncover each item.



Arty Heart

- Cut a heart shape from cardstock or scrap cardboard.
- Find pictures and words in magazines that show God's love.
- Arrange them on your heart, adding your own artwork and other reminders of His love.
- Once you're happy with the design, glue everything down and hang it up.

SUNDAY AT A GLANCE

THE VERSE

We love Him because
He first loved us.
1 John 4:19 NKJV

THE INTRODUCTION

God's never-ending love
fills and flows through us.

THE DEVOTIONAL

Daddy used grape juice
to show how God pours
His love into our hearts—
and how we pour it
into others.

THE PRAYER

Thank You, Lord, for
pouring Your love into
my life.

THE CONVERSATION

Where did you notice
God's love today, and
how will you share it with
someone else?